

A photograph of several purple mushrooms with white gills growing on a bed of green moss. The background is a soft-focus green forest.

The Melia Slouch Top

Written Pattern

     [whymsirow](#)



Introduction

Welcome to The Melia Slouch Top crochet pattern. Thank you for your purchase and get ready to make something magical!

Please read ALL of the pattern including the 'Pattern Notes' section itself before you begin work, or things may get a bit confusing!

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If you have any questions about this pattern, please first check out my [FAQ](#) and [Blog](#) for further information, pattern help and lots of useful general crochet resources! If you find you're still struggling, please don't hesitate to reach out with any further questions via my [website](#) or [Etsy](#).

Please contact me directly wherever you have purchased this pattern. Please do not use my [Instagram](#) or other socials for pattern help, but that's a good place for more general chit chat or to share your finished work!

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Materials

Notions

Hooks: 3.5mm and 4mm

Essential notions: Yarn needle, scissors, flexible measuring tape, at least four locking stitch markers

Optional: Small beads

Advised: Tools for blocking

Yarn

(For information on substitutions, read 'A Note on Yarn Choice' in the Pattern Notes, pg. 3)

Ribbed Waist:

70g DK yarn, or LIKELY MORE or LESS more depending on your size (see Sizing, pg. 4)

- I used Utopia Crafts Perfect DK in colour Woodland Green (approx. 210m/230yds) for the piece depicted in this pattern.

Leaf Lace:

150g 4 Ply yarn, or LIKELY MORE or LESS more depending on your size (see Sizing, pg. 4)

- I used King Cole Simply Footsie 4 Ply in colour Olive (approx. 645m/705 yds) for the piece depicted in this pattern.

Abbreviations

Ch	Chain
Sl st	Slip stitch
Sc	Single crochet
BLO	Back loop only (these stitches are worked in the back loop only of the previous row's stitches)
Dc	Double crochet
dc2tog	Double crochet 2 together (decrease of 1 stitch)
Sk	Skip
Nxt	Next
Chsp	Chain space
Ea st	Each stitch
...	Repeat this portion of the step between the asterisks as many times as instructed

Important! '2dc' vs 'dc 2'

- '2dc' is an *increase*. This means work TWO double crochet stitches into the SAME next stitch or chain space.
- 'dc 2' is *not* an increase. This means work ONE double crochet stitch into EACH of the next two stitches.

Pattern Notes

This pattern uses US Standard crochet terms.

Right Side & Wrong Side: “RS/WS”

- All of this pattern is made in the traditional style of turning your work over in between each step/row, meaning that you alternate working from the ‘right’ side and the ‘wrong’ side of your work.
- Throughout the pattern, this is clearly specified at the start of steps when relevant with the following abbreviations to help you keep track of where you are amidst repeating steps:
 - RS: Right Side (the outside of your piece)
 - WS: Wrong Side (the inside of your piece)

STARTING CHAINS and Stitch Counts

- For every step of this pattern, I specify whether that row/round’s starting chain counts as a stitch, so pay attention as you go because it varies!
- If the starting chain does NOT count as a stitch:
 - The pattern will clearly state that the starting chain of that step ‘does not count as st’.
 - These starting chains which do not count as stitches are not included in any stitch counts which may be given.
 - Example: “Ch1 (does not count as st), sc in ea dc and ch sp across. Turn your work over. [27sts]”

- Note: For this example, you would work your first sc in the very first available stitch of the previous row.

- If the starting chain DOES count as a stitch:
 - The pattern will clearly specify what stitch (and potentially chains) the starting chain constitutes.
 - These starting chains which count as stitches are included in any stitch counts which may be given.
 - If the starting chain counts as a stitch, ‘skip’ the first stitch of the previous row and begin working in the second stitch.
 - Example: “Ch4 (counts as dc and ch1), sk 1, dc, *ch1, sk1, dc*, repeat *...* across. Turn your work over. [27sts]”
 - Note: For this example, you would work your first true dc in the *third* stitch of the previous row, because you were told to skip an additional stitch (“sk 1”) in addition to first stitch of the previous row you should already have skipped, as explained just above.

A note on YARN CHOICE

For the leaf lace portion of this project, look for a 4 Ply weight yarn, also known as a #1 Super Fine Weight or “sock, fingering or baby” weight yarn. These yarns typically recommend a hook size of 2.25-3.5mm. By using a 3.5mm hook for this section of the pattern, you will get a top with lovely, flowy drape! The yarn I used is approximately 430m or 470yds per 100g: when substituting, look for similar metreages/yardages.

Sizing – Read me carefully!

Get out your flexible tape measure!

It is important that you first take your waist measurement: A: _____.

The Melia Slouch Top is not quite made to measure, **because there are some limitations as to the possible circumference of the ribbed waist portion.** This is because the columns of the leaf lace of the top have a fixed width which must be accommodated.

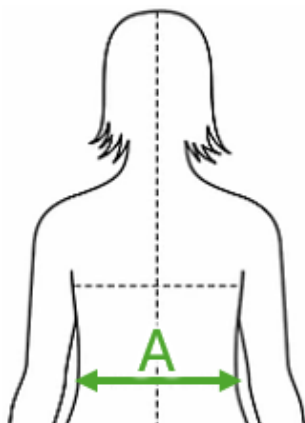
The ribbed waist portion of the slouch top is made first by repeating a few repeating steps (pg 5). This ribbed waist portion must be made with a certain number of rows to accommodate the columns of leaf lace which will be worked off of it.

To the right, you can see a chart of the possible rows of ribbing for the waist portion and the resulting waist circumference measurement you can expect if you meet the gauge below.

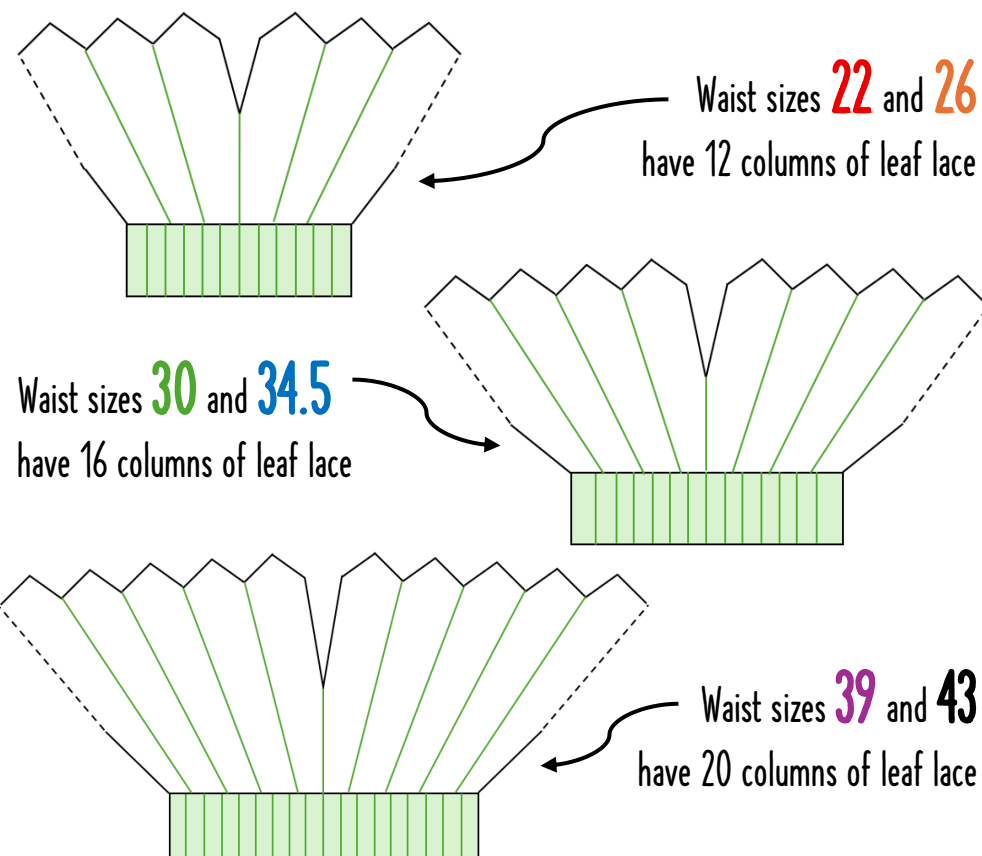
These measurements are for the waist when *unstretched*. Because the waist portion is ribbed, it is very stretchy and the top is designed to fit snugly/stretched around your waist. Because of this, err on side of the option that is on the small side if you are between ribbing row counts.

GAUGE: 2 x 2 inches or 5 x 5 cm = 10 hdc BLO x 6 rows

- This gauge is for half double crochet stitches worked in the back loop only.
- This is the ribbing stitch used for the ribbed waist portion of the top.



# of ribbing rows in waist portion	60	72	84	96	108	120
Approx. waist circumference of top <i>unstretched</i> (inches)	22	26	30	34.5	39	43
Total columns of leaf lace	12	12	16	16	20	20
Set Up Row stitch count (Don't worry! Explained in Method)	90 (+18)	108	126 (+18)	144	162 (+18)	180



Method:

Waist Portion

The ribbed waist portion of this top is 30 stitches wide (vertically). You can, however, make it narrower or wider as you like. Simply add or subtract chains to the starting chain.

- As the pattern is written, there are 32 starting chains, because the waist portion will be 30sts wide, plus you need 2 turning chains. $[30 + 2]$.
- However many stitches wide you make the waist portion, you will still need 2 turning chains! I.e. if your waist portion is X stitches wide, you will need $[X + 2]$ starting chains.

Use one strand of DK yarn and a 4mm hook.

Chain 32.

In 3rd ch from hook:

1. Hdc 30. [30sts]
 2. Ch2 (does not count as st), hdc BLO 30. [30sts]
 3. Repeat Step 2 until your waist piece is the appropriate number of total rows for your body size, as you've determined from the 'Sizing' section (pg. 4).
- Secure the ends of your piece temporarily with locking stitch markers and check that you can pull it on over your head and that it fits snugly around your waist.
 - Then remove the stitch markers and work a simple slip stitch seam to attach the two ends together, forming a complete circle/cylinder (see in **PINK** to the right). Do not fasten off.



Set-Up Row for the Leaf Lace

The Set-Up Row for the leaf lace is created by working half double crochet evenly along the top edge of your waist piece. This means you are working perpendicular into the side/edge of the rows of your waist piece.

Continuing to use the same one strand of your DK yarn and a 4mm hook:

1. Hdc 3 into the edge of every 2 rows of your ribbed waist piece. Sl st to 1st st. *[see chart on pg. 4 for resulting stitch count]*

If your ribbed waist portion had 72, 96 or 120 rows of ribbing: fasten off, skip the following Step 2 and proceed on to the next section 'Leaf Lace'.

If you worked **60**, **86** or **108** rows: turn your work and complete Step 2 before proceeding.

2. Ch2 (does not count as st), *hdc [**4**, **6**, **8**], 2hdc*, repeat *...* in ea st around. Sl st to 1st st and fasten off. *[st count increase of 18sts for all sizes]*



Method:

Leaf Lace

The leaf lace comprises of six initial beginning rows, then it is simply **the same three rows repeated over and over**- easy!

- You will be turning your work over in between each row of the lace, alternating between working from the right side (RS) and wrong side (WS) of your work.
- No stitch counts are given because your stitch count will depend on the length of your ribbed waist piece and the stitch count of the Set-Up Row you just worked.
- The repeating portion of each step is in **BOLD** to help you focus on it for the majority of each round.
- On the following pages, you can find a stitch diagram of the repeating portion (*...*) of repeating Steps 7-9, as well as a close-up photo of the leaf lace. It may be helpful to refer to these in conjunction with the written steps to better understand stitch placement. But don't worry if diagrams aren't your thing- all of the info is covered in the written steps!

Use one strand of your 4 Ply yarn and a 3.5mm hook.

From the right side (RS) of your work, attach your yarn to any stitch of the Set-Up Row at the centre-back of your waistband (near the seam at the back).

1. RS: ch5 (counts as dc and ch2), sk1, 2dc, 2dc, ch2, dc, ch2, 2dc, 2dc, ch2, sk1, dc, ***dc, ch2, sk1, 2dc, 2dc, ch2, dc, ch2, 2dc, 2dc, ch2, sk1, dc***, repeat *...* in ea st around. Sl st to 3rd ch of starting chain and turn.
2. WS: ch5 (counts as dc and ch2), sk chsp, 2dc, dc 2, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, in central dc of previous row: [dc, ch1, dc], ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, dc 2, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ***dc, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, dc 2, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, in central dc of previous row: [dc, ch1, dc], ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, dc 2, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc***, repeat *...* in ea st around. Sl st to 3rd ch of starting chain and turn.

3. RS: ch5 (counts as dc and ch2), sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, ch4, sk chsp, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ***dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, ch4, sk chsp, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, dc***, repeat *...* in ea st around. Sl st to 3rd ch of starting chain and turn.
4. WS: ch5 (counts as dc and ch2), sk chsp, dc2tog, dc 2, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, 2dc, ch2, dc in chsp (working around the ch), ch2, 2dc, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc 2, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ***dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc 2, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, 2dc, ch2, dc in chsp (working around the ch), ch2, 2dc, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc 2, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc***, repeat *...* in ea st around. Sl st to 3rd ch of starting chain and turn.
5. RS: ch5 (counts as dc and ch2), sk chsp, dc2tog, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, dc 2, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, in central dc of previous row: [dc, ch1, dc], ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, dc 2, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, dc 2, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, in central dc of previous row: [dc, ch1, dc], ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, dc 2, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc2tog, ch2 sk chsp, dc*, repeat *...* in ea st around. Sl st to 3rd ch of starting chain and turn.
6. WS: ch5 (counts as dc and ch2), sk chsp, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, ch4, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ***dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, ch4, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc***, repeat *...* in ea st around. Sl st to 3rd ch of starting chain and turn.
7. RS: ch5 (counts as dc and ch2), sk chsp, dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc 2, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, 2dc, ch2, dc in chsp (working around the ch), ch2, 2dc, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc 2, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ***dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc 2, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, 2dc, ch2, dc in chsp (working around the ch), ch2, 2dc, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc 2, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc***, repeat *...* in ea st around. Sl st to 3rd ch of starting chain and turn.

8. WS: ch5 (counts as dc and ch2), sk chsp, dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, dc 2, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, in central dc of previous row: [dc, ch1, dc], ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, dc 2, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc, *dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, dc 2, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, in central dc of previous row: [dc, ch1, dc], ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, dc 2, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc*, repeat *...* in ea st around. Sl st to 3rd ch of starting chain and turn.
9. RS: ch6 (counts as dc and ch3), sk [chsp, dc, chsp], dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, ch4, sk chsp, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, ch3, sk [chsp, dc, chsp], dc, *dc, ch3, sk [chsp, dc, chsp], dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, ch4, sk chsp, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, ch3, sk [chsp, dc, chsp], dc*, repeat *...* in ea st around. Sl st to 3rd ch of starting chain and turn.
10. WS: Repeat Step 7
11. RS: Repeat Step 8
12. WS: Repeat Step 9

Repeat Steps 7-9 like this until the leaf lace reaches the point where you would like the V of your neckline to sink to when worn. This will be at a 'low point' between two columns of leaf lace (see below in **PINK**).



- **Finish on a repeat of Step 8.** Do not fasten off.
- Refer to the stitch diagram on Page 9 if you find diagrams helpful!
- The next step is to divide your lace into four parts (the front-right and front-left halves, and the back-right and back-left halves) in order to create arm holes and the neck hole.
- The Melia Slouch Top is designed to have a relaxed/slouched and oversized fit, with a deeper neckline.
- Remember that blocking can increase the overall length of your leaf lace significantly (see pg 12). It may be a good idea to block the leaf lace you have so far completed to get an idea of this.

Dividing for the Arms and Neck

Using locking stitch markers, mark the columns of leaf lace into FOUR (4) equal amounts. These correspond to the front-right and front-left halves, and the back-right and back-left halves of your top. Mark in the 'low points' between columns of leaf lace, between the 2 dc sts found there.

- If you have 12 columns of leaf lace, divide into 4 sets of 3 columns
- If you have 16 columns of leaf lace, divide into 4 sets of 4 columns
- If you have 20 columns of leaf lace, divide into 4 sets of 5 columns





Continuing where you left off, having turned your work:

13. RS/WS: ch3 (counts as dc), dc in same st, ch3, sk [chsp, dc, chsp], dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, ch4, sk chsp, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, ch3, sk [chsp, dc, chsp], dc, ***dc, ch3, sk [chsp, dc, chsp], dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, ch4, sk chsp, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, ch3, sk [chsp, dc, chsp], dc***, repeat *...* in ea st up to your next stitch marker. Dc again in final st. Turn.
14. WS/RS: ch3 (counts as dc), dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc 2, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, 2dc, ch2, dc in chsp (working around the ch), ch2, 2dc, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc 2, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ***dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc 2, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, 2dc, ch2, dc in chsp (working around the ch), ch2, 2dc, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc 2, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc***, repeat *...* in ea st up to your next stitch marker. Dc in final st. Turn.
15. RS/WS: ch3 (counts as dc), dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, dc 2, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, in central dc of previous row: [dc, ch1, dc], ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, dc 2, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ***dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, dc 2, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, in central dc of previous row: [dc, ch1, dc], ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, dc 2, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc***, repeat *...* in ea st up to your next stitch marker. Dc in final st. Turn.

16. WS/RS: ch3 (counts as dc), dc, ch3, sk [chsp, dc, chsp], dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, ch4, sk chsp, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, ch3, sk [chsp, dc, chsp], dc, ***dc, ch3, sk [chsp, dc, chsp], dc2tog, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, 2dc, ch4, sk chsp, 2dc, ch2, sk chsp, dc 6, ch2, sk chsp, dc2tog, ch3, sk [chsp, dc, chsp], dc***, repeat *...* in ea st up to your next stitch marker. Dc in final st. Turn.

17. RS/WS: Repeat Step 14

18. WS/RS: Repeat Step 15

19. RS/WS: Repeat Step 16

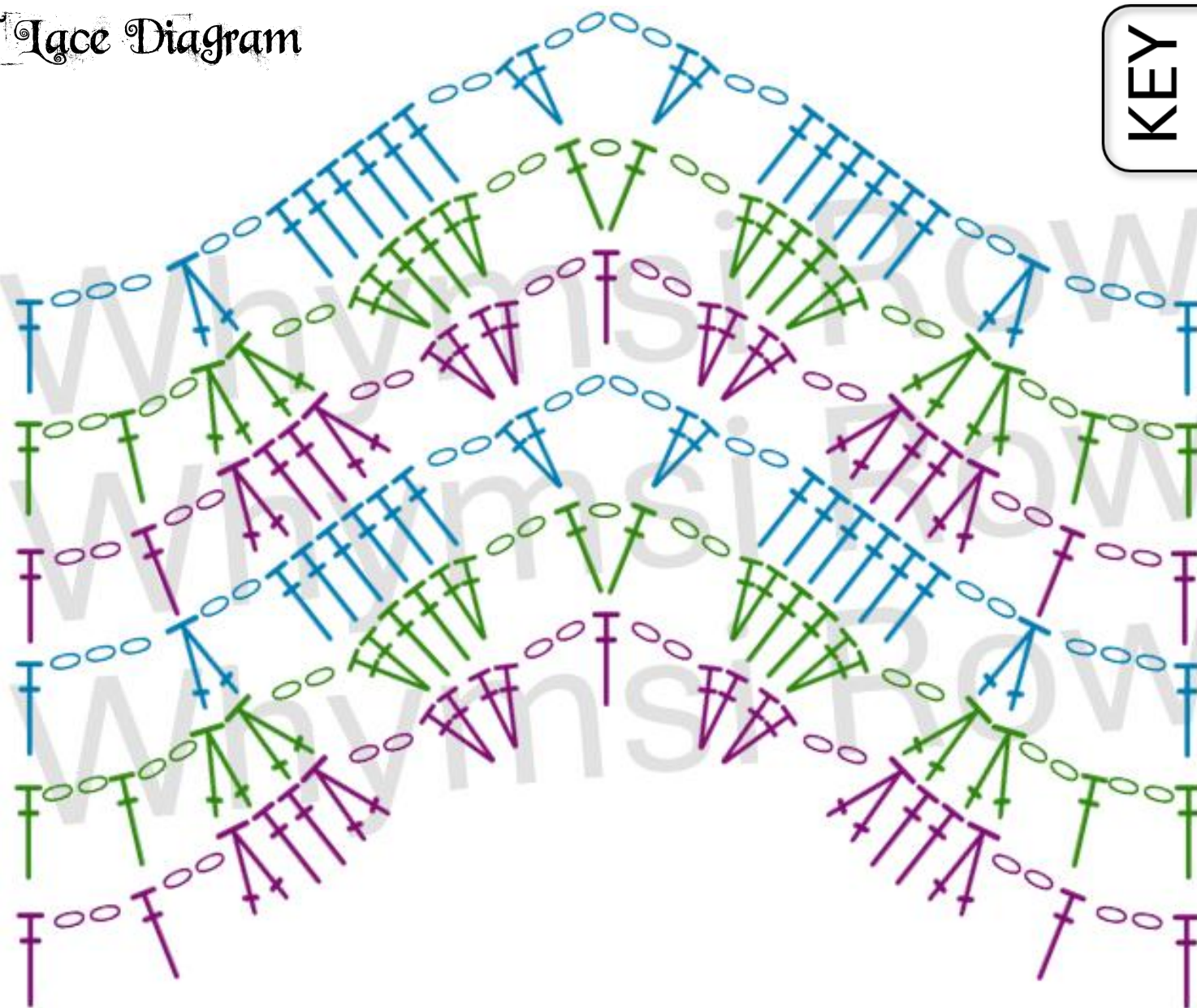
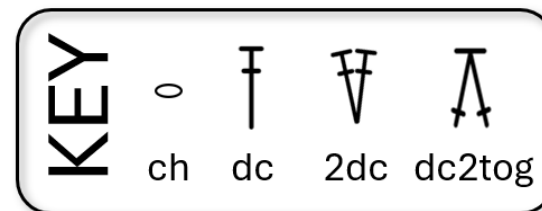
Repeat Steps 14-16 like this until the leaf lace reaches the top of your shoulder at its highest points when worn. Then fasten off.

- **Finish on a repeat of Step 14.**
- Make a note of how many total rows you work as you will need to work the exact same number for each quarter of your top (see below).

Reattach your yarn and repeat this process three more times for each quarter of your top (the front-right and front-left halves, and the back-right and back-left halves).



Leaf Lace Diagram



Repeat Row 9

Repeat Row 8

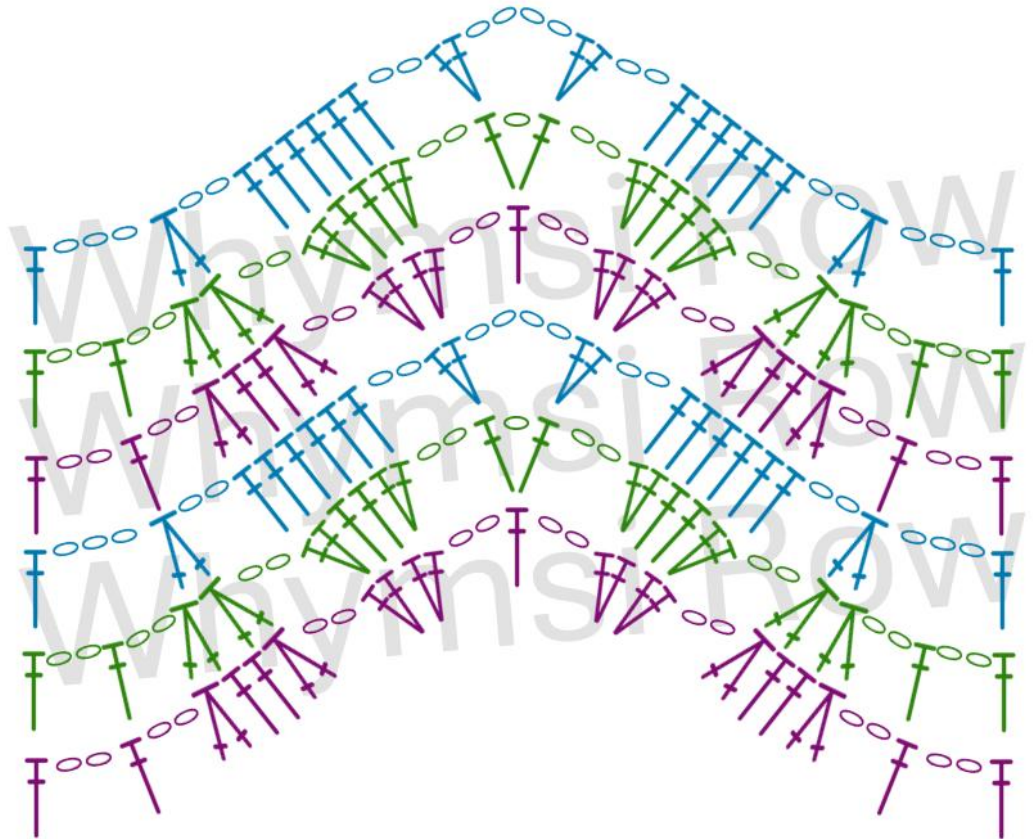
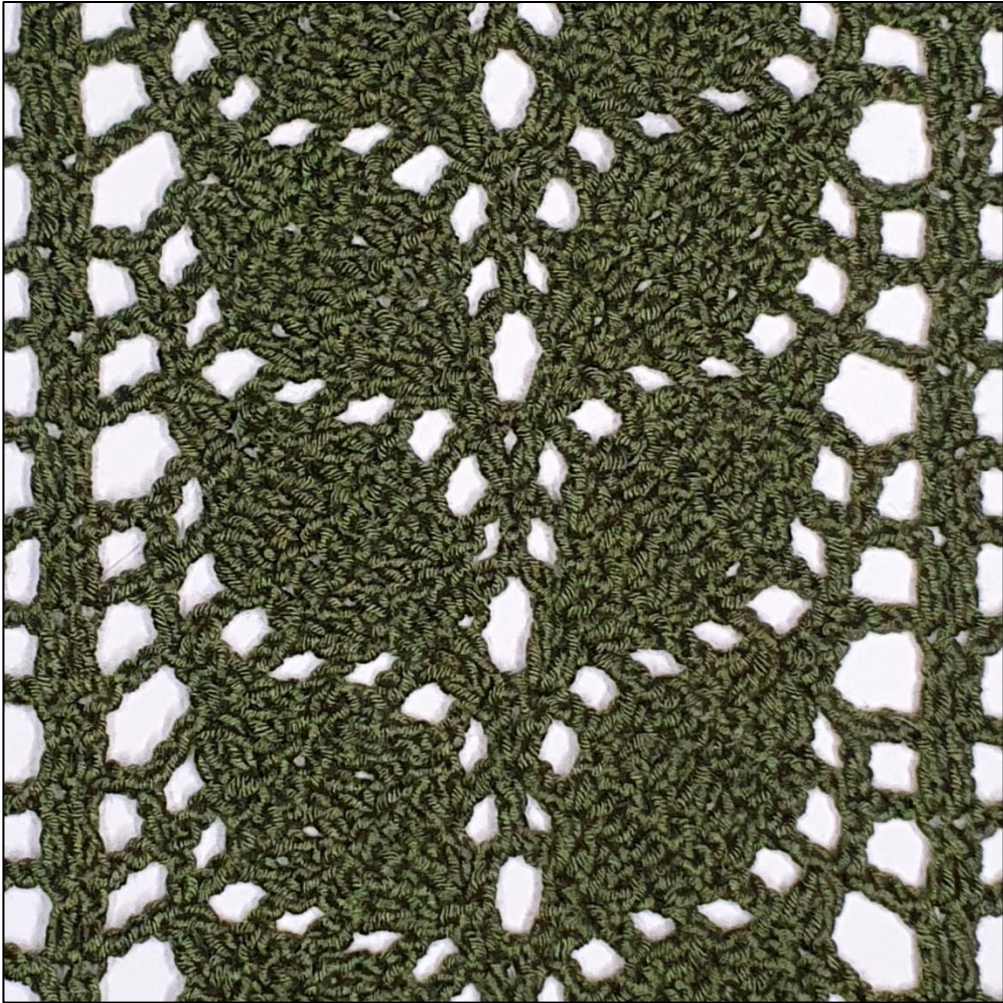
Repeat Row 7

Row 9

Row 8

Row 7

Leaf Lace Diagram alongside the work



Blocking the leaf lace may increase the overall length of your top because blocking relaxes stitches. Keep this in mind when stitching- you may want to try blocking your work at the recommended checkpoints before fastening off in order to test the overall length when worn.



Shoulders & Beading



Now it's time to sew together the 'high points' of your top's front and back at the shoulders. Depending on the size of your top, this will either be at 6, 8 or 10 places.

To do this, line up the 'high points' as seen to the left. Then simply use a yarn needle and a length of your 4ply yarn. Sew through the top of the central dc stitches at each of these 'high points' on both the front and back of your top. Sew back and forth at least twice to ensure a strong, secure fit. Then double or triple knot securely and weave in ends.

Adding beads is entirely optional! You might want to add one or two beads at each point as I have done, as can be seen below. Sew back through the beads again once or twice to ensure a strong, secure fit.



Congratulations!

You're finished- go you! Try on your Melia Slouch Top, have fun styling it in different ways and make sure to wear it on your next adventure!

Thank you so much for working with my pattern to create something whimsical! Remember to tag me in any posts you make on Instagram or TikTok @whymsirow as I always love to see customer's creations. I hope you've had fun, and please remember to utilize my [FAQ](#) and [Blog](#) for further information, pattern help and lots of useful general crochet resources! If you find you're still struggling, please don't hesitate to reach out with any further questions via my [website](#) or [Etsy](#).

♥ Row

